

Yoga: An Introduction

The term "yoga" comes from Sanskrit, meaning "union." Yoga combines physical exercises (asanas), mental meditation, and breathing techniques (pranayama) to strengthen muscles and relieve stress.

Asanas as Preventive Measures

According to Patanjali, "Sthiram sukham asanam" means 'that position which is comfortable and steady'. Asanas are a means through which physical and mental development is achieved, preventing diseases and delaying aging.

Benefits of Asanas for Preventing Diseases:

- Bones and joints become strong.
- Muscles strengthen, and their efficiency increases.
- Blood circulation improves, and blood pressure normalizes and stabilizes.
- Lung capacity and chest size increase, making respiratory organs more efficient.
- Efficiency of the digestive system increases, improving food absorption.
- Nervous system strengthens, increasing neuromuscular coordination.
- Excretory system efficiency improves.
- Immune system strengthens, helping prevent various diseases.

Obesity

Obesity is a condition where the amount of fat in the body increases to an extreme level. BMI (Body Mass Index) is helpful for calculating the obesity level.

Asanas for Obesity:

- Tadasana
- Katichakrasana
- Pavanmuktasana
- Matsayasana
- Halasana
- Pachimottansana
- Ardha-Matsyendrasana
- Dhanurasana
- Ushtrasana
- Suryabedhan pranayama

Diabetes

Diabetes is a condition that impairs the body's ability to process blood glucose (blood sugar).

Asanas for Diabetes:

- Katichakrasana
- Pavanmuktasana
- Bhujangasana
- Shalabhasana
- Dhanurasana
- Supta-vajarasana
- Paschimottanasana
- Ardha-Mastendrasana
- Mandukasana
- Gomukasana
- Yogmudra
- Ushtrasana
- Kapalabhati

Asthma

Asthma is a disease of the lungs in which airways become blocked, causing difficulty in breathing. Airways also swell up and produce extra mucus, triggering coughing, sneezing, or shortness of breath.

Asanas for Asthma:

- Tadasana
- Urdhwahastottansana
- UttanMandukasana

- Bhujangasana
- Dhanurasana
- Ushtrasana
- Vakrasana
- Kapalbhati
- Gomukhasana
- Matsyaasana
- Anuloma-Viloma

Hypertension

Hypertension is a condition in which the force of the blood against the artery walls is too high. Usually defined as blood pressure above 140/90 mmHg, and considered severe if above 180/120 mmHg.

Asanas for Hypertension:

- Tadasana
- Katichakransan
- Uttanpadasana
- Ardha Halasana
- Sarala Matyasana
- Gomukhasana
- UttanMandukasana
- Vakrasana
- Bhujangasana
- Makarasana
- Shavasana
- Nadishodhanapranayam
- Sitlipranayam